



Generosity

CSMN, 5 December 2025



Statements:

- The more you have, the more you want.
- The more you have, the less you're satisfied.
- The more you have, the more people (including the government) will come after it,
- The more you have, the more you realize it does you no good
- The more you have, the more you have to worry about.
- The more you have, the more you can hurt yourself by holding on to it
- The more you have, the more you have to lose.
- The more you have, the more you'll leave behind.

(from Randy Alcorn, *Giving is the Good Life*)

Think briefly about which one(s) make most sense to you.



Chinese for generosity/generous

- 慷慨 (kāngkǎi) ??
- 大方 (dàfāng) ??
- 宽宏大量 (kuānhóng dàliàng) ??
- 善良 (shànliáng) ??

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The essence

The Bible is a unified story about God's generosity towards the world, inviting us to receive out of His abundant goodness and grace, and to then share generously with others what we have received.

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Think for a moment:
Have you ever met a truly generous person?

- What effect did this have on you?
- How did it make you feel?

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Generosity – not just about giving things

- Generosity as attitude
- as outlook on life
- as mentality
- as lifestyle
- as a way to approach the world and the people around you

Generosity can be expressed in many different ways, not just in relation to material things.

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What other words express a similar meaning as generosity/being generous?

- Freely giving
- Compassionate
- Grace/gracious
- Forgiving
- Magnanimous
- Kind/kindness
- Love (loving kindness)
- Grant, lavish, satisfy

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Opposite words

- Greed/greedy
- Stingy
- Being harsh
- Withdrawing, withholding
- Stealing, robbing
- Take advantage of
- Abusing

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Fulfilling the purpose of generosity through an appropriate response

- Consider it as something you have a right to?
- Take it for granted?
- Appreciate?
- Enjoy?
- Be thankful?

Enjoyment and thankfulness take generosity to perfection!

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Imagine: from tomorrow, all world leaders
express a generous attitude towards each other

- What difference would that make?



Let's learn from Scripture about this generous God

Psalm 103 from verse 2

Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits [all He is **giving**]:

- He forgives your iniquities (wrongdoings);
- He heals your diseases;
- He redeems your life from destruction;
- He crowns you with lovingkindness and tender mercies;
- He satisfies your desire for good.



Continued from Psalm 103

From verse 8 David continues on God's generous **being**:

- The Lord is merciful and gracious;
- He is slow to anger;
- Abounding in love;
- He does not treat us as our sins deserve;
- He does not repay us according to our iniquities;
- His love for those who turn to him is unmeasurable;
- He removes our transgressions from us, infinitely far away;
- As a father has compassion on his children, that is how He has compassion on those who turn to Him.



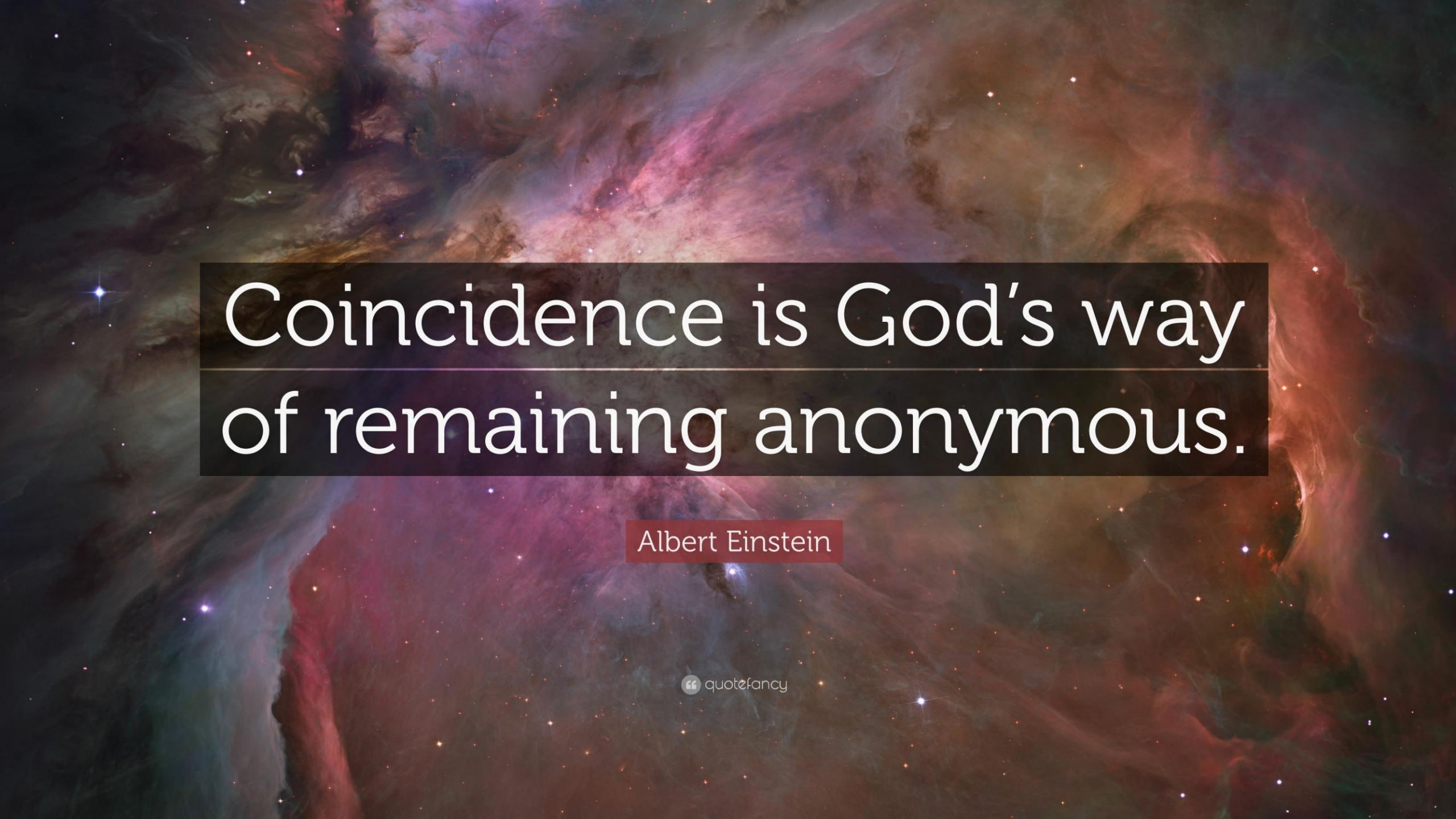
Continued from Psalm 103

**God does not choose to (sometimes) be generous –
He IS generous in his very nature!**

- But, from everlasting to everlasting the Lord's love is with those who turn to him, and
- “The Lord established his throne in heaven and his kingdom rules over all”

God has unlimited resources for being generous!

His generosity never runs out.



Coincidence is God's way
of remaining anonymous.

Albert Einstein

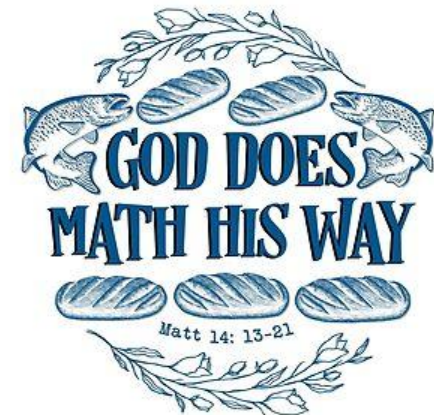


The ultimate proof of God's generosity towards us

- “God demonstrates his own love for us in this: while we were still sinners (wrongdoers), Christ died for us.” Romans 5:8
- “This is how God showed his love among us: He sent his one and only Son into the world that we might live through him. This is love: not that we loved God, but that he loved us and sent his Son as an atoning sacrifice for our sins.” 1 John 4:9-10

Learning to imitate God's generosity – where to start?

- Requires a **change of mentality**
 - Scarcity, or
 - Abundance
- Requires a **change of perspective and expectation**
 - $5+2 + \text{prayer} = \text{abundance}$

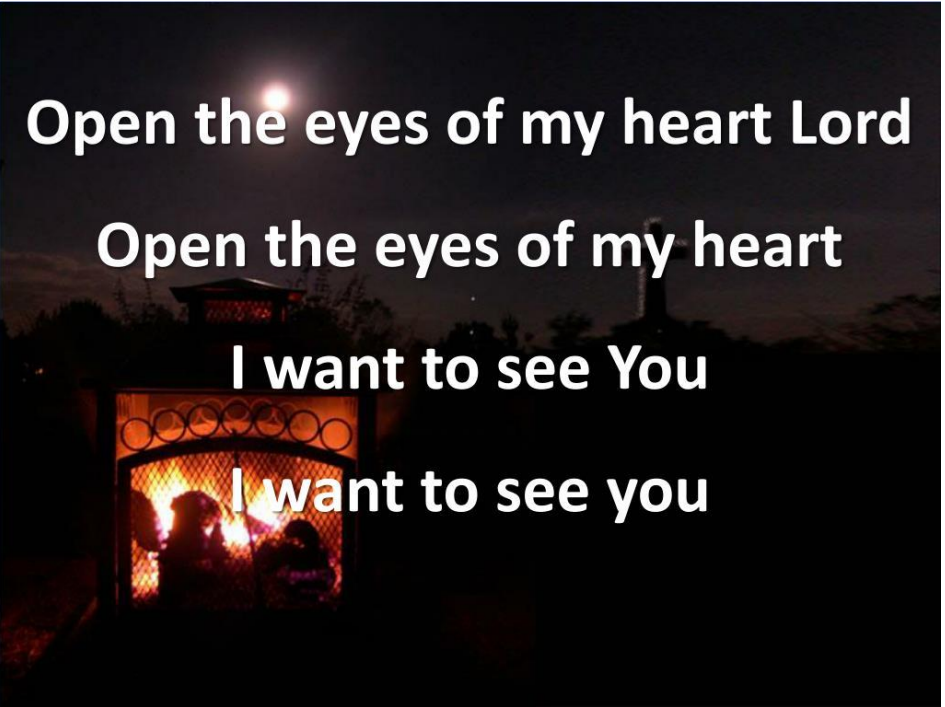


We need God's Holy Spirit to change us

- Requires a **change of heart attitude**
 - “open the eyes of my heart, Lord” – Seeing God is a generous God
 - “soften my heart, Lord” – I want to imitate His generosity

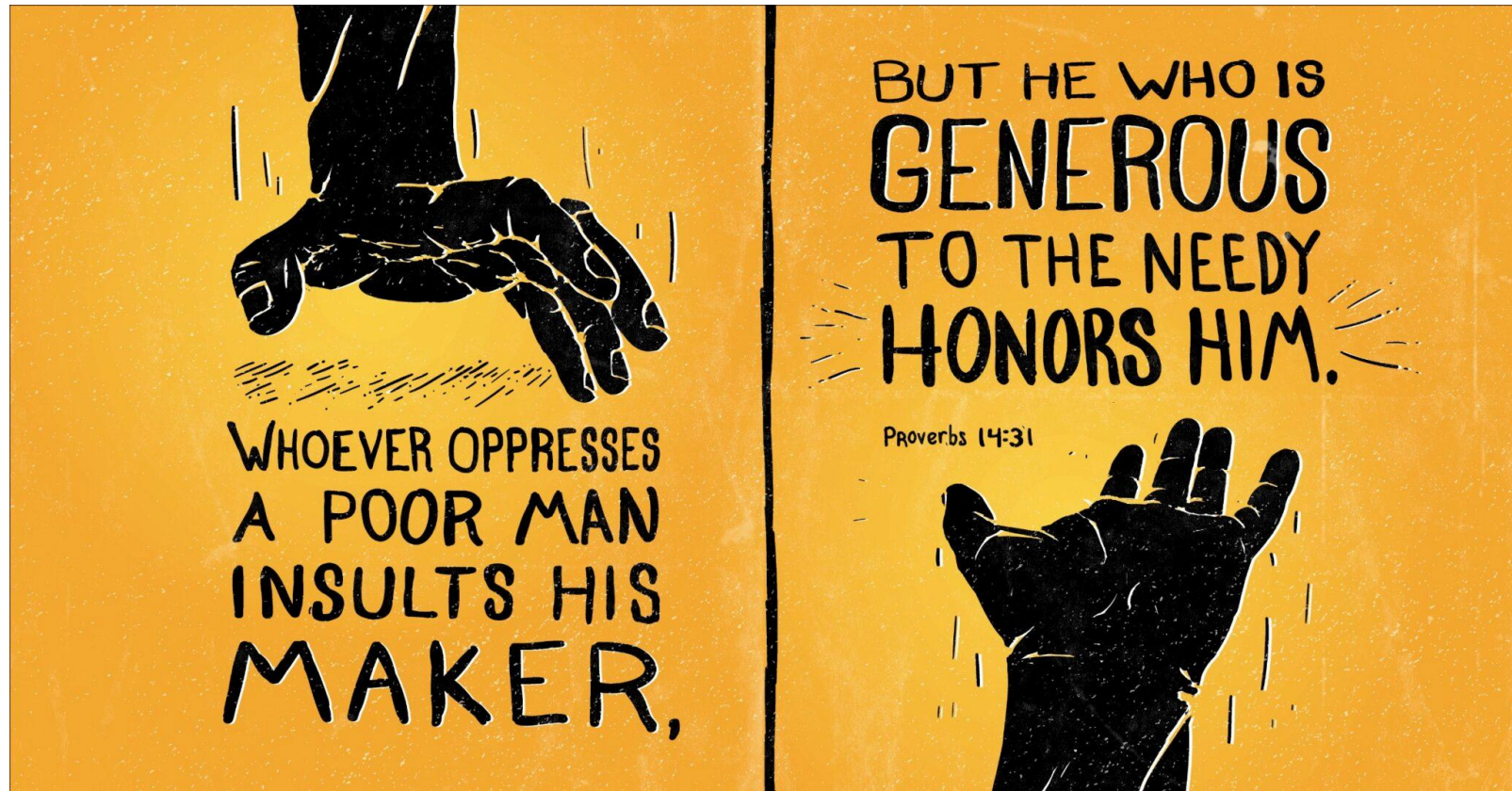


***Soften my heart, Lord
Soften my heart
From all indifference
Set me apart
To feel Your compassion
To weep with Your tears
Come soften my heart, O Lord
Soften my heart.***



**Open the eyes of my heart Lord
Open the eyes of my heart
I want to see You
I want to see you**

Let's learn some more on how we can imitate our heavenly Father – learning to be generous as He is generous





Open a heavenly bank account!

- Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. *For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.*

Matt. 5:19-21

***"FOR WE BROUGHT NOTHING
INTO THIS WORLD,***



***AND IT IS CERTAIN
WE CAN CARRY NOTHING OUT."***

1 TIMOTHY 6:7 (KJV)



Revolutionary generosity

- Luke 6 from verse 27

“Love your enemies, do good to those who hate you, bless those who curse you, pray for those who mistreat you. (...)

Do to others as you would have them do to you. If you love those who love you, what credit is that to you” – anybody can do that.

“And if you do good to those who are good to you, what credit is that to you?” – anybody can do that. (..) “But love your enemies, do good to them, and lend to them without expecting to get anything back. (...)

Be merciful, just as your Father is merciful.” (...) Forgive, and you will be forgiven. Give, and it will be given to you”

A decorative graphic on the left side of the slide featuring several autumn leaves in shades of red, orange, and yellow, with some leaves showing detailed vein patterns.

God is good for us all

He Makes His Sun
Rise on The Evil
and on The Good
and Sends Rain on
The Just and on
The Unjust
Matthew 5:45





Command those who are rich in this present world not to be arrogant nor to put their hope in wealth, which is so uncertain, but to put their hope in God, who richly provides us with everything for our enjoyment.

Command them to do good, to be rich in good deeds, and to be generous and willing to share.

1 Timothy 6:17-18



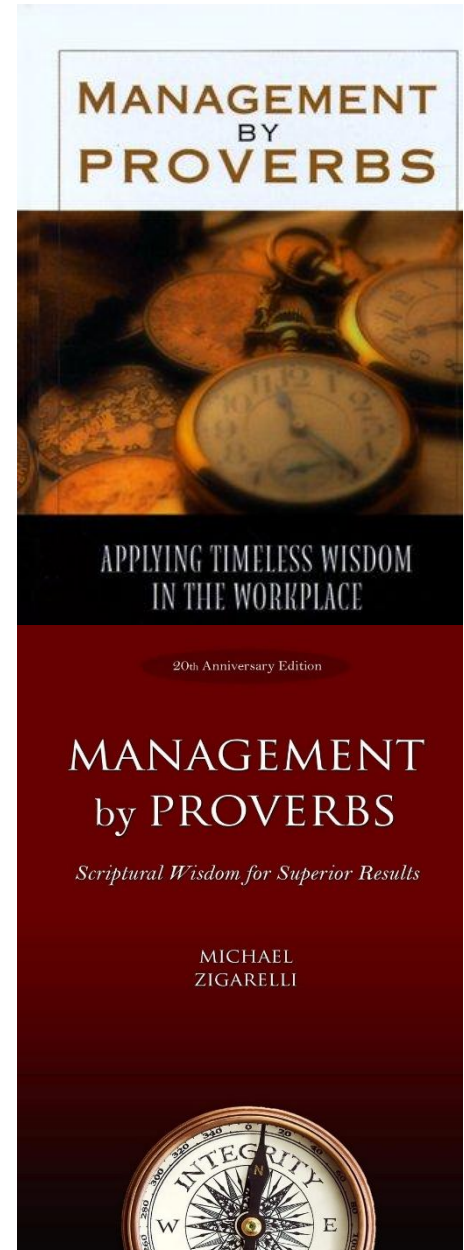
Would this apply to the business world as well?

Management by Proverbs – applying timeless wisdom in the workplace

- Applications in the business environment

“A generous man/woman will prosper; the one who refreshes others, will himself/herself be refreshed (Proverbs 11:25)

“A generous man/woman will himself/herself be blessed, for he/she shares his/her food with the poor” (Proverbs 22:9)



**JESUS SAID TO THEM,
“WATCH OUT! BE ON
YOUR GUARD AGAINST
ALL KINDS OF GREED
LIFE DOES NOT CONSIST
IN AN ABUNDANCE OF
POSSESSIONS.”**

LUKE 12:15







Generosity is love in action

From 1 Corinthians 13:

Love is patient

Love is kind

Love does not envy

Love is not proud

Love is not rude

Love is not self-seeking

Love is not easily angered

Love keeps no record of wrongs

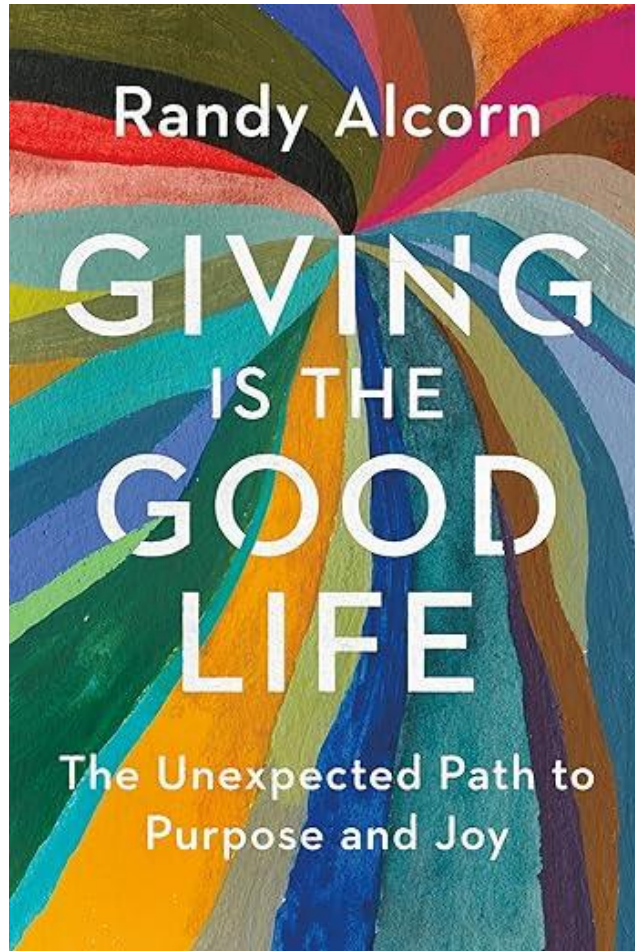


Lord, make me an instrument of your peace — by John Michael Talbot

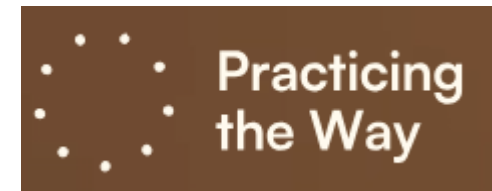
- **A song about a generosity mindset**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j1s1-WJ8nbA>

Learn more about the invitation to a lifestyle of generosity



The Generosity Practice Session 01: There is More Joy in Giving Than Receiving



On Youtube and Spotify



Conversation 1: read five statements

- Jesus was right: Happiness is found in the opposite place than where we are often told. There is more happiness in living simply and generously than in acquiring money and possessions.
- A key thing to learn about following Jesus is discovering the joy of living a generous life.
- There are two ways of looking at the world and that will define one's ability to be generous:
 - An abundance mindset (trusting there will be enough for your needs)
 - A scarcity mindset (worrying that there may not be enough for oneself)
- We tend to think about what we may give away (hopefully we do that), but what about turning the question around: what is it that I may keep?
- The majority of Jesus' teachings on money are warnings about the danger of greed.

Which of these sentences resonate with you – which do you find puzzling – why?



Conversation 2:

- The Bible encourages us to see wealth through the lens of stewardship (taking good care), not ownership (it's just for me).

Do you understand what this means? What do you think about it?

- Someone said: a defining characteristic of a disciple of Jesus is their generosity to the poor.

Do you recognize this? What do you think about it?

- God blesses us to give more, not just to have more.

Just think about it.

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To end with: what is for you the **key take-away message** from everything you've heard? Is there anything you may want to (learn to) apply in **practice**?

First think about it for a few minutes –
then pray together in your group:

- what is your response to this subject?
- pray a generous blessing over each other.